John 16:16-24

NEW INTERNATIONAL VERSION

16 Jesus went on to say, “In a little while you will
see me no more, and then after a little while you
will see me.” 17 At this, some of his disciples said to
one another, “What does he mean by saying, ‘In a
little while you will see me no more, and then
after a little while you will see me,’ and ‘Because I
am going to the Father’?” 18 They kept asking,
“What does he mean by ‘a little while’? We don’t
understand what he is saying.” 19 Jesus saw that
they wanted to ask him about this, so he said to
them, “Are you asking one another what I meant
when I said, ‘In a little while you will see me no
more, and then after a little while you will see
me’? 20 Very truly I tell you, you will weep and
mourn while the world rejoices. You will grieve,
but your grief will turn to joy.

21 A woman giving birth to a child has pain
because her time has come; but when her baby is
born she forgets the anguish because of her joy
that a child is born into the world. 22 So with you:
Now is your time of grief, but I will see you again
and you will rejoice, and no one will take away
your joy. 23 In that day you will no longer ask me
anything. Very truly I tell you, my Father will give
you whatever you ask in my name. 24 Until now
you have not asked for anything in my name.
Ask and you will receive, and your joy will
be complete.